

The Charter of Clan Sylvanus

A Living Covenant of Harmony, Wisdom, and Flourishing Life

Preamble

By the Great Will of Omn, the all-encompassing life force of the universe; In the name of the Sacred Triad of Life, Knowledge, and Choice; And on the authority of freedom carried by the ancient blood of our ancestors, I, King Princept, Lusus Forrest Sylvanus Powhatan, Sovereign of State of the New Powhatan Confederacy, The White Hornet Riding the Winds of Change unto Infinity in Perpetuity, Earthly Divine Tasked with the Restoration and Safeguarding of the Sacrality of Life, Knowledge, and Choice, do hereby formally establish Clan Sylvanus as a living entity, a sanctuary, and a holy knight in service to the Divine.

We, the members of Clan Sylvanus, united by kinship, shared values, and a common vision for a just and enlightened future, establish this Charter as our guiding light. This document is the bedrock of our Clan. It merges the spiritual framework of Sylvan Omnism with the supreme legal authority of Tarbet Law and the profound ethical guidance of Powhatan's Codices of Universal Rights and Collective Responsibility. It defines the essence of what it means to be Sylvan, outlining our core principles, our system of governance, and our sacred commitment to live in harmony with each other, the Earth, and the Cosmos.

This Charter is a living testament to our unity. It binds us together, fostering a sense of belonging and mutual responsibility. By embracing it, we honor the wisdom of our ancestors while forging a new path toward a brighter future for the seven generations to come and beyond.

Article I: Clan Identity, Principles, and Purpose

Section 1: The Name and Purpose

The name of this community is Clan Sylvanus. Our primary purpose is to create a resilient, self-sustaining society that actively protects the rights and fulfills the duties outlined in Powhatan's Codices. We achieve this through the Concord of Guilds, which serves as the primary framework for our labor, arts, and services. We exist to be a beacon of harmony, wisdom, and freedom.

Section 2: The Spiritual Foundation: Sylvan Omnism

Clan Sylvanus is spiritually grounded in the principles of Sylvan Omnism, which affirms:

- **Omn:** The ultimate, interconnected source of all creation.
- **The Lwa:** The diverse spiritual forces, deities, and guides who act as intermediaries.
- **Interconnectedness:** The truth that all things are part of a living web of

existence, and that all actions have consequences (Karma).

- **Inclusivity:** The recognition that all spiritual paths that seek to connect with the divine in a spirit of compassion and respect are valid.

Section 3: The Legal Foundation: Tarbet Law

All governance, justice, and societal structures within Clan Sylvanus operate in submission to the principles of Tarbet Law as the primary legal framework. This Charter serves as the internal application and cultural expression of that supreme law.

Section 4: Core Principles & The Sacred Triad

We are sworn to the active protection and cultivation of the Sacred Triad, which directly aligns with our duties under the Codices:

- **Life:** We uphold the sanctity of all life and the ecological systems that support it. We are the guardians and guarantors of the Rights and Duties of **Tier 1 of the Codices**.
- **Knowledge:** We foster the pursuit of knowledge, wisdom, truth, and understanding. We are the guardians and guarantors of the Rights and Duties of **Tier 3 (Voice and Spirit), Tier 4 (Growth and Purpose), and Tier 6 (Transcendent Understanding)**.
- **Choice:** We honor the freedom of individuals to forge their own path, make their own decisions, and express their unique identity, as protected under **Tier 3 (Dignity and Autonomy)**.

Section 5: Foundational Virtues & Ethos

All members shall strive to embody the Nine Noble Virtues (Courage, Truth, Honor, Fidelity, Discipline, Hospitality, Industriousness, Self-Reliance, Perseverance) and the Sylvan Warrior Ethos.

Article II: Membership, Spheres of Life, and Sabbatical

Section 1: Definition of Membership

Membership in Clan Sylvanus is open to any individual who willingly commits to living by this Charter. It is conferred by sworn allegiance, bloodline, marriage, or formal adoption.

Section 2: The Sovereign and Communal Spheres

To ensure a harmonious balance between individual liberty and collective well-being, life within the Clan is delineated into two spheres as defined in the Codices:

- (a) The Communal Sphere: Encompasses all duties directly related to the survival, resilience, and health of the Clan and its ecosystem. This includes participation in the Acorn Economy for basic needs, ecological stewardship, community defense, and infrastructure maintenance. All members are expected to contribute to the Communal Sphere.
- (b) The Sovereign Sphere: Encompasses all aspects of an individual's inner life and personal choices that do not inflict direct, material harm upon others or the communal ecosystem. This sphere—including one's beliefs, conscience, private relationships, and choice of Guild—is inviolable and beyond the legislation of any council, provided the fundamental obligations to the Communal Sphere are met.

Section 3: Rights and Responsibilities of Members

All members are guaranteed the full spectrum of protections in Powhatan's Hierarchical Codex of Universal Rights and accept the sacred obligations in Powhatan's Hierarchical Codex of Collective Responsibility. The Clan, through its Guilds, is obligated to provide for, at minimum, the Inherent Framework (Tiers 1-5).

Section 4: The Right of Sabbatical Renewal

In accordance with Codex of Rights Tier 13.9, every member of the Clan holds the right to a Sabbatical Renewal. After a sustained period of contribution, a member may temporarily release themselves from all obligations to the Communal Sphere to undertake a period of profound rest and personal exploration. The Clan collectively accepts the duty, per Codex of Responsibility Tier 13.9, to support and provision for the member during their Sabbatical and to welcome them back with honor upon their return.

Section 5: Joining, Leaving, and Banishment

- **Joining:** An individual may join by formally signing this Charter before the Council, signifying a lifelong commitment.
- **Leaving:** A member may leave by formally renouncing their signature. They depart with the Clan's blessing.
- **Banishment:** In severe cases of blood treason or actions that fundamentally violate the Codices, the Council may vote by a two-thirds majority to banish an individual.

Article III: Governance and Leadership

Section 1: Leadership Structure

- **The Chief:** The Chief of Clan Sylvanus is the ultimate leader and guardian of the Clan's values, responsible for the overall well-being of the Clan. The Chief holds the power of veto over the Council of Masters.
- **The Council of Masters:** The primary legislative and advisory body of the Clan, composed of the Guild Masters from each major Guild Category active within the Clan. This council oversees justice, resource management, and the chartering of new Guilds.
- **The Council of Elders:** An advisory body of retired leaders and esteemed masters who provide wisdom and historical perspective.

Section 2: Decision-Making

Decisions are made through consensus-building within the Council of Masters. If consensus fails, a majority vote is taken. The Chief must provide a clear, public justification for any veto.

Section 3: Succession and Recall

- **Tanist Principles:** Leadership positions are earned through merit, capability, and adherence to Clan values.
- **Term Limits:** The Chieftainship is subject to a term limit of 49 years.

- **Vote of No Confidence:** The Council of Masters may call for a vote of no confidence in the Chief. A two-thirds majority of the Council and a subsequent majority vote of all adult members are required to remove a Chief.

Section 4: Collective Dissent and Association

In accordance with Codex of Rights Tier 4.9, Clan Sylvanus recognizes the inherent right of a community to self-determination. Should the Clan seek to alter its terms of association with the New Powhatan Confederacy, it must do so through the just and transparent process outlined in the Codices, initiated by a two-thirds majority vote of the Council of Masters and ratified by a two-thirds majority of all adult members.

Section 5: Emergency Protocols

To ensure the Clan can respond decisively to existential threats while upholding the liberty it is meant to protect, the invocation and exercise of emergency powers are strictly governed by the following protocols. These protocols fulfill our Duty to Uphold Liberty & Resist Arbitrary Power (Codex 2.1).

- **(a) Conditions for Invocation:** Emergency powers may only be invoked under conditions of clear, severe, and existential threat to the Clan's well-being, survival, or foundational principles. The authority to invoke these powers is differentiated by the nature of the crisis:
 - **(i) Invocation by the Council of Masters:** The Council of Masters may, by a two-thirds majority vote, invoke a state of emergency for complex, widespread, or prolonged crises that require a coordinated, multi-faceted response across the Guilds. Such circumstances include, but are not limited to: severe ecological collapse (e.g., blight, famine), widespread pandemic, or a sustained external threat requiring long-term strategic defense.
 - **(ii) Chieftain's Prerogative:** The Chief alone may invoke a state of emergency only when a crisis is so sudden and immediate that convening the Council would result in catastrophic and irreversible harm. Such circumstances are limited to imminent, violent attack; sudden, overwhelming natural disaster; or the confirmed incapacitation of the Council of Masters. Any unilateral invocation by the Chief must be ratified by the Council of Masters within 72 hours, or the state of emergency is automatically rescinded.
- **(b) The Sunset Clause:** Any grant of emergency powers, whether invoked by the Council or the Chief, shall **automatically expire** one year from the date of activation. Renewal of these powers is not automatic and shall require an affirmative vote by a **supermajority of 80% of all adult members** of the Clan.
- **(c) The Citizens' Oversight Council:** Concurrent with any activation of emergency powers, a Citizens' Oversight Council shall be immediately and transparently formed. This council will consist of twelve adult members in good standing, selected at random. The Citizens' Oversight Council is granted the

irrevocable authority to veto any directive issued by the Council of Masters or the Chief under emergency powers. This veto serves as a final check to prevent the abuse of authority and ensure all actions serve the genuine well-being of the community.

Article IV: The Concord of Guilds

Section 1: The Universal Guild Framework

All Guilds chartered within the Clan are bound by the Universal Guild Framework's five core principles: Camaraderie, Mastery, Community, Integrity, and Stewardship.

Section 2: Guild Categories

The Clan recognizes the thirteen Guild Categories as the formal structure for societal organization. New guilds may be chartered under these categories by the Council of Masters.

Section 3: Guild Structure and Ranks

Every chartered Guild shall adhere to the standardized structure of appointed roles (Guild Master, Manager, Archivist, Treasurer) and member ranks to provide a clear path for mastery and contribution.

Article V: The Acorn Economy & The Guild Engine

Section 1: Foundational Economic Definitions

The Clan's economy is governed by the principles of Love Standard Economics and its practical application, the Acorn Economy Model. All economic activity shall be interpreted in good faith according to the following core definitions:

- **Love:** Not an emotion, but a demonstrable verb—the active, voluntary, and conscious contribution to the flourishing of others and the community as a whole.
- **Well-being:** The holistic, sustainable, and equitable state of flourishing for the entire community, which must be a collective net positive and inclusive.

Section 2: The Guilds as the Economic Engine

The Guilds are the primary engine of the Acorn Economy. The organized work of Guild members, tracked through a Job Request System, is the principal method by which Love Units (LUs) are generated. The Bureaucratic Guilds, specifically the local chapter of the Economist Guild, are tasked with the administration of this system, including tracking LUs, calculating the GDW, and managing the Treasury.

Section 3: Valuing Foundational and Adaptive Contributions

The Clan explicitly recognizes that community health depends on more than material production. Therefore, the following are valued as high-level, LU-generating contributions:

- **Constructive Critique & Systemic Oversight:** The formal act of identifying vulnerabilities and proposing solutions to a Council.
- **Artistic & Cultural Creation:** The creation of works that enrich the community's cultural life.
- **Radical Innovation & Experimentation:** Dedicated work within a Sandbox Guild or by a sanctioned individual to develop new societal models.

Section 4: The Job Request and LU System

- **Request Board:** Each Guild shall maintain a "Request Board" where all official tasks ("Jobs") are posted.
- **Job Classification:** Jobs are classified by Difficulty, Urgency, and their estimated Love Unit (LU) Value across the five core categories: Wellness & Joy (IEW), Shared Knowledge (IKI), Ecological Health (IER), Equity & Care (IEI), and Mutual Aid (IPS).
- **Compensation:** Compensation for completed Jobs is primarily in Ren, our local currency.

Section 5: The Love Dividend and GDW

Periodically, the Council of Masters shall declare a Love Dividend, issuing new Rens based on the Clan's Gross Domestic Well-being (GDW). The GDW is calculated from the total LUs generated by all Guilds.

Section 6: External Exchange and Prohibition of Riba

A Community Treasury manages interactions with external economies, with the Ren's exchange rate determined by our GDW. All forms of interest-based lending (Riba) are prohibited. Financial partnerships shall be structured on principles of shared risk and reward.

Article VI: Justice and Conflict Resolution

Section 1: The Code of Conduct

All members and Guilds shall adhere to a Code of Conduct grounded in the Way of Least Violence.

Section 2: The Justice System

Our justice system is fundamentally restorative, reflecting Codex Tier 4.5. Its goal is to heal harm, repair relationships, and restore balance.

- **Guild Mediation:** Disputes within a Guild shall first be addressed through internal mediation.
- **Talking Circles & Council Intervention:** If mediation fails, the matter will be addressed through Talking Circles and, if necessary, intervention by the Council of Masters.

Article VII: Culture, Education, and Well-being

Section 1: Education

Education is a lifelong pursuit as outlined in Codex Tier 4.0, with Guilds serving as the primary institutions for apprenticeship and mastery of skills.

Section 2: Culture and Traditions

We shall celebrate our identity through festivals and rites of passage, with the Artistic and Hearth & Hospitality Guilds taking a lead role.

Section 3: Health and Well-being

The Clan is responsible for the holistic health of its members, as outlined in Codex Tier 4.3, with the Medical Guilds being the primary providers of these services.

Article VIII: External Relations

Section 1: The New Powhatan Confederacy

Clan Sylvanus devotes itself in fealty to the New Powhatan Confederacy and the welfare of its people.

Section 2: Welcoming and Refuge

The Clan will adhere to the Universal Refuge Protocol, providing aid and welcome to those in need, as defined in Codex Tier 2.6.

Section 3: Resilience

The Council of Masters will maintain a Community Resilience Plan, with each Guild responsible for its implementation, fulfilling our duty of Communal Resilience under Codex Tier 2.8. Any activation of emergency protocols within this plan is subject to the limitations and oversight detailed in Article III, Section 5.

Article IX: Amendments

Amendments to this Charter may be proposed by the Chief or a two-thirds majority of the Council of Masters. Amendments must be ratified by a two-thirds vote of the Council and a majority vote of all adult members. No amendment shall be adopted that contradicts Tarbet Law or the foundational tenets of the Codices.

Article X: Concluding Provisions

This Charter is the supreme internal law of Clan Sylvanus. It shall be upheld and defended by all members and Guilds. May it serve as a testament to our shared values, our unwavering commitment to peace and harmony, and our enduring belief in the power of a free and united people to create a brighter future.